

F.5 FUTURE INVESTIGATORS IN NASA EARTH AND SPACE SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY

NOTICE: April 16, 2026. The month of the pre-proposal webinar in 12.7 on page 26 has been corrected. It will occur in May, not April.

Amended April 14, 2026. This amendment releases final text for this graduate student research program, which was previously TBD. Neither notices of intent nor Step-1 proposals are requested nor accepted. Proposals are due July 14, 2026.

An optional, pre-proposal webinar for all potential proposers will occur May 28 at 1 p.m. Eastern Time, and the Earth Science Division optional office hours via Teams will occur June 23 and 24 at 1 p.m. Eastern Time, see Section 12.7 for start times for all events.

Any FINESST updates will be posted on [the NSPIRES page for this program element](https://go.nasa.gov/FINESST25) at <https://go.nasa.gov/FINESST25>.

Table of Contents

1. Introduction and Funding Opportunity Description	2
2. Scope of Program: Division Research Overviews	3
2.1 Earth System Science Research Program	3
2.2 Heliophysics Research Program	5
2.3 Planetary Science Research Program	6
2.4 Astrophysics Research Program	7
2.5 Biological and Physical Sciences Research Program	7
2.6 Science Activation and Citizen Science	8
3. Additional Information on ROSES Other Cross-Division Research Programs	9
4. FINESST Program Eligibility	9
4.1 International Traffic in Arms Regulations, Export Administration Regulation, Foreign Institutions, and the People's Republic of China	10
4.2 Data Limitations and Requirements	11
5. Proposal Preparation and Submission	11
5.1 Content of a FINESST Proposal	12
5.1.1 Anonymized Document	13
5.1.1.1 Science/Technical/Management Section – ANONYMIZED	13
5.1.1.2 References	13
5.1.1.3 Open Science and Data Management Plan – ANONYMIZED	13
5.1.1.4 Mentoring Plan or Agreement – ANONYMIZED	14
5.1.2. Expertise and Resources Not Anonymized Document	14
5.1.2.1 Research Readiness Statement – NOT ANONYMIZED – Limit 1 page	14
5.1.2.2 Biosketch – NOT ANONYMIZED- No page limit	15
5.1.2.3 Current and Pending Support – NOT ANONYMIZED- No page limit	15
5.1.2.4 Statements, Letters, and Facility, Equipment, and Other Resources – NOT ANONYMIZED	15
5.1.2.5 Acknowledgements - NOT ANONYMIZED – Limit 150 words	16
5.1.2.6 Budget and Narrative – NOT ANONYMIZED	16
5.1.2.7 Optional High-End Computing Appendix – NOT ANONYMIZED	18
5.2 Preparing Proposals for Dual-Anonymous Peer Review	18
5.3 Late Proposals	20

6. Proposal Evaluation	20
6.1 Compliance Check.....	20
6.2 Review.....	20
6.2.1 Scientific Merit Criterion	21
6.2.2 Relevance Criterion	21
6.2.3 Research Readiness Criterion	21
6.2.4 Cost Reasonableness Criterion.....	22
7. Award Information and Restrictions.....	22
8. Reporting Requirements	22
9. Collection of Demographic Information	23
10. Points of Contact and Frequently Asked Questions	23
11. Summary of Key Information	23
12. Ancillary Information for Proposers.....	24
13. Ancillary Information for Awardees	32

1. Introduction and Funding Opportunity Description

Future Investigators in NASA Earth and Space Science and Technology (FINESST) solicits proposals from accredited U.S. universities and other eligible organizations for graduate student-designed and performed research projects that contribute to the Science Mission Directorate's (SMD) science, technology, and exploration goals. The Future Investigator (FI), i.e., the student, shall have the primary initiative to define the proposed FINESST research project and must be the primary author, with input or supervision from the proposal's Principal Investigator (PI), as appropriate.

The proposal must present a well-defined research question, a justification for its scientific significance to achieving the goals and objectives of SMD, and a detailed discussion of the approach to be used to answer the question. All FINESST proposals must also explain relevance to at least one participating SMD program or division. Proposers should consult [Section 2](#) for a partial list of eligible research topic(s).

Information on NASA's Strategic Goals and Objectives and SMD's high-level objectives is in the [NASA 2022 Strategic Plan](#) and [the Fiscal Year \(FY\) 2026 Annual Performance and Evaluation Plans](#). The NASA Science Strategy or Plan for the Science Mission Directorate entitled [2025-2026 NASA Science Plan: A Vision for Scientific Excellence](#) and [NASA Implementation of Executive Order 14303, Restoring Gold Standard Science](#) explain SMD's principles.

FINESST awards are research grants. See also [Section 7, Award Information and Restrictions](#), and [Section 13, Ancillary Information for Awardees](#).

FINESST is a program element or appendix to the NASA Research Announcement (NRA) Research Opportunities in Space and Earth Sciences (ROSES) described in [Section 12.1](#) entitled, "The Structure of ROSES and its Relationship to Other Guidance". These FINESST instructions supersede guidance provided in [the NASA Grant and Cooperative Agreement Manual \(GCAM\)](#) and [the ROSES-25 Summary of Solicitation](#).

2. Scope of Program: Division Research Overviews

This section presents a partial overview of research funded by SMD relevant to this opportunity. Proposers may refer to the list of program element(s) solicited by a division(s) or across divisions in [Table 3 of ROSES-25](#) to get an indication of topics. NOTE: Not all ROSES program elements and their topics are eligible for FINESST proposals. This is especially true of elements in Appendices C (Planetary Science) and E (Biological and Physical Science). Please read sections 2.3 and 2.5 in this opportunity carefully.

Proposals for research that cross SMD's divisional boundaries, e.g., sun-climate connection, upper/lower atmosphere connection, comparative planetary atmospheres and/or atmosphere/surface interactions, Earth as an analogue for exoplanets, common physical/chemical data, and/or processes in support of modeling or observations may be considered by the relevant divisions.

If proposers, have research eligibility questions, then they should email HQ-FINESST@mail.nasa.gov and one or more of the Points of Contact in [Section 11](#) well in advance of the proposal due date.

2.1 Earth System Science Research Program

Compelled by our planet's rapid change, the Earth Science Division (ESD) is innovating, exploring, and collaborating with the public and private sector to understand the Earth system, make new discoveries, and enable solutions for the benefit of all. ESD delivers the technology, global observation data, expertise, and applications that help NASA deliver trusted actionable Earth science to support the US economy, support national security with valuable information and tools, improve the nation's ability to forecast and respond to severe storms, droughts, wildland fires, and other natural hazards, and support decision-making that affects human health and quality of life.

To achieve the goals outlined above, NASA ESD understands the need of cultivating a variety of communities across multiple Earth science disciplines at early stages in their careers. The ESD Early Career Research Program ([ECR](#)) creates opportunities to advance the development and implementation of the [Earth Science to Action \(ES2A\) strategy](#). ECR is striving for excellence in Earth science by supporting outstanding and innovative scientific research, enabling greater participation through scientific leadership, fostering a sense of community through sustained relationships, and making Earth science data more usable and impactful for the benefit of humanity. FINESST Earth is one of several projects within the ECR Program.

Proposals must demonstrate the relevance of their research activities to support one or more of the following ESD program elements; if a proposal is fully applicable to two or more programs, then that should be clearly indicated on the NSPIRES cover page. Note: it is extremely important that proposers read the following sections to select the corresponding research topic on the cover page. Earth Science proposers should review ROSES-2025 [A.1 Earth Science Research Overview](#) for additional details:

- The Earth Science Technology Office ([ESTO](#)) fosters the creation and infusion of cutting-edge sensors, information systems, and a variety of other projects to develop breakthrough technologies that can improve Earth observations and

make Earth science research easier, more efficient, more cost effective, and more robust. Research in this focus area include new instrument systems that are smaller, require less power, and are more capable, and information systems technologies such as data processing, interoperability, visualization, and analysis as well as autonomy, modeling, and mission architecture design – to enable new scientific measurements of the Earth system or reduce the cost of current observations.

- Earth Science Data Systems ([ESDS](#)) oversees the life cycle of NASA's Earth science data—from acquisition through processing and distribution. The program aims to make NASA's Earth science data open, interactive, interoperable, and accessible to all. Research in this focus area includes the management and analysis of Earth science data using methods and tools such as Artificial Intelligence and Machine Learning (Deep Learning), big data, innovative data visualization, and cloud computing to address Earth science questions.
- Earth System Science Research Program ([ESSRP](#)) advances Earth system science by enabling the use of satellite, airborne, and ground-based observations, along with modeling approaches, to improve understanding of Earth processes. The new ESSRP focus areas are Atmosphere, Biosphere, Cryosphere, Geosphere, and Hydrosphere. Interdisciplinary proposals that address more than one of the focus areas also are encouraged. For full description of the research spheres please visit the [ESSRP website](#).
- Earth Action Program (EA) supports applied research and applications development projects that enable the use of NASA Earth science information for decision-making. Research in this focus area aims to address the [Earth Science to Action \(ES2A\) strategy](#) by 1) scaling, 2) building bridges, and 3) conducting work in a user-centered way. Research areas in EA include Ecological Conservation, Energy and Infrastructure, Health and Air Quality, Water Resources, Agriculture, Disasters Risk and Resilience, and Wildland Fires. For a full description of the EA applied research components, refer to ROSES-2025 [A.1 Earth Science Research Overview](#).

Proposals must demonstrate a clear linkage to past, present, or future NASA Earth science data and/or models (see the [Earth Science to Action Strategy](#)). This linkage could include, but is not limited to: NASA satellite remote sensing data (including joint missions of NASA and its interagency and international partners), remote sensing data that pertains to future NASA observing systems, remote sensing and in-situ data from NASA or NASA-affiliated suborbital activities such as airborne campaigns and surface-based networks, data acquired via NASA's Commercial SmallSat Data Acquisition ([CSDA](#)) Program (available at no cost to U.S. Government-funded researchers), NASA models that incorporate satellite and/or suborbital data, and technology projects related to current and future NASA observing systems. Proposals that incorporate non-NASA data, including international satellite data, commercial satellite data, and social science data are welcome but the main source must be NASA data. Any data proposed to be analyzed from any source, including NASA and other satellite data, ancillary data, and data from commercial sources, must be at the time of proposal submission, publicly available in the sense that these data are openly accessible. Proposals should reflect the principles of Open Science as described on the [Earthdata website](#).

2.2 Heliophysics Research Program The primary goal of NASA's Heliophysics Division (HPD) is to understand the Sun, its interactions with the Earth and Solar System bodies, and space weather. The HPD research program is guided by both the 2025-2026 NASA Science Plan (See Section 1 of this document) and by the National Research Council's 2024 decadal survey, *The Next Decade of Discovery in Solar and Space Physics: Exploring and Safeguarding Humanity's Home in Space*.

The HPD FINESST program supports the full range of research that improves our understanding of the fundamental processes and interconnections across all of heliophysics. These investigations can span a broad range of spatial and temporal scales, ranging from those relevant to atmospheric gravity wave transport to those appropriate for the heliosphere. To that end, HPD FINESST welcomes a broad range of topics, that could include (for example):

- The Sun, including processes taking place throughout the solar interior and its atmosphere, as well as the evolution and cyclic activity of the Sun.
- The origin and behavior of the solar wind, transient structures, energetic particles, and magnetic fields in the heliosphere and their interaction with the Earth and other planets, as well as with the interstellar medium.
- The physics of magnetospheres, including (but not limited to) magnetic reconnection, fundamental interactions of plasma wave-particle interactions and particles with guide fields, as well as coupling to the solar wind and ionospheres.
- The physics of the terrestrial mesosphere, thermosphere, and ionosphere, neutral and ionized, and coupling of these phenomena to the lower atmosphere and magnetosphere.
- Those processes that create space weather events, and investigations to enable a capability for predicting future space weather events.

Proposers to the HPD FINESST program are encouraged to familiarize themselves with the full range of topics supported by NASA's Heliophysics Division, as articulated in [ROSES-2025 B.1 Heliophysics Research Program Overview](#). Because of the cross-disciplinary nature of Heliophysics and FINESST, HPD welcomes cross-disciplinary proposals into atmospheric, planetary, and exoplanetary environments if these investigations firmly establish their connection with comparative heliophysics or directly inform processes immediately relevant to heliophysics.

The HPD FINESST Program supports theory, modeling, and data analysis proposals. Proposals may utilize a wide range of data sources, including remote sensing and *in-situ* measurements. All Heliophysics relevant data is supported by HPD FINESST, including data taken by a wide range of platforms, including satellites, balloons, rockets, and other modalities. Regardless of the data sources, proposals to the HPD FINESST are expected to follow the Data Eligibility requirements found in Section 1.6 of the [ROSES-2025 B.1 Heliophysics Research Program Overview](#). All proposals to HPD FINESST must follow the SMD open science data management plan as outlined in Section 5.1.1.3 of this document.

2.3 Planetary Science Research Program

Planetary Science proposers should review [ROSES-2025 C.1 Planetary Science Research Program Overview](#) for complete information about the Planetary Science Research Program. For more information about mission data and astromaterials eligibility, please see Section 3.5 in C.1.

The Planetary Science Research Program, managed by the Planetary Science Division (PSD), supports investigations to help ascertain the content, origin, and evolution of the solar system and the potential for life elsewhere, consistent with [the Planetary Science Decadal Survey Origins, Worlds, and Life: A Decadal Strategy for Planetary Science and Astrobiology 2023 – 2032](#) (OWL) and the strategy for Planetary Science Exploration embodied in [NASA's Science Strategy](#).

Proposals that are relevant to PSD must address a priority of the Planetary Science Division:

- “The Twelve Priority Science Questions” in Table 3.1 of [OWL](#)
- NASA Planetary Science Strategic Objectives 1.2 and 1.3 of the [NASA Strategic Plan 2022](#)
- The goals of the Planetary Science Division as described in [NASA's Science Strategy](#)

Proposals need not be hypothesis-driven. Proposals that involve analysis of planetary data (e.g., mission, ground-based) are allowed and may include the generation of higher-order data products, archiving data sets or products, generation of new reference information, such as laboratory measurements, and creation of geologic maps. The development and dissemination of software tools that facilitate the use of existing datasets or that would enable or enhance future science investigations are also in scope.

Proposals that seek to develop new proof-of-concept instruments or instrument components, including sampling technologies, that enable new science by significantly improving instrument measurement capabilities for planetary science missions and are at low Technology Readiness Levels (i.e., TRL 1-3) are allowed. The proposal must justify the entry and exit TRL of the proposed technology; to do so, proposers are encouraged to reference [NASA SP-20205003605](#), “*Technology Readiness Assessment: Best Practices Guide*.”

Science topics related to exoplanets may be relevant to either the Planetary Science or Astrophysics Divisions. The Planetary Science Division is interested in proposals related to fundamental processes of exoplanets, such as atmospheric escape and evolution, or studies that use solar system planets as proxies for exoplanets.

Proposals for missions, mission concepts, mission operations and system software, or platform technologies such as materials and structures, power generation or conditioning, communications, small satellites, landers, rovers, or any spacecraft technology are not solicited.

2.4 Astrophysics Research Program

Astrophysics proposers should review the [ROSES-25 D.1 Astrophysics Research Overview](#) for complete information regarding the Astrophysics Division goals and possible relevance of their FINESST proposals.

The Astrophysics Research Program, managed by the Astrophysics Division, has the strategic objective to discover how the universe works, explore how it began and evolved, and search for life on planets around other stars.

The science goals of proposed FINESST investigation shall include one or more of the following:

- Probe the origin and destiny of our universe, including the nature of black holes, dark energy, dark matter, and gravity.
- Explore the origin and evolution of the galaxies, stars and planets that make up our universe.
- Discover and study planets around other stars and explore whether they could harbor life.
- Develop cutting-edge technologies to support NASA Astrophysics research, including, but not limited to, detector developments, supporting technologies (e.g., optics, mirrors, coatings, or gratings), and laboratory Astrophysics investigations.
- Advance astrophysics opportunities aligned with NASA's Artemis/Moon/Mars exploration program. This includes, but is not limited to, technologies, infrastructure, communication, and observations from the Moon's surface or orbit, across wavelengths and time regimes.

Investigations submitted to the Astrophysics research program must explicitly support past, present, or publicly announced future NASA astrophysics missions (e.g. Habitable World Observatory). These investigations may include theory, simulation, data analysis, laboratory astrophysics, and technology development.

Science topics related to exoplanets may be relevant to either the Astrophysics or Planetary Science Divisions. The Astrophysics Division is interested in proposals aimed at discovering and characterizing planets outside our solar system to study their variety, formation, and potential for life. Astrophysics is interested in finding and confirming planets orbiting other stars, studying their properties, including their atmospheres, learning how planets form and evolves, as well as obtaining data and test models aimed at study exoplanets that may be able to harbor life, particularly those in the habitable zone around their stars. Proposers are encouraged to consult the "[Astrophysics Biennial Technology Report \(pdf\)](#)" and the associated "Technology Gaps".

2.5 Biological and Physical Sciences Research Program

Biological and Physical Sciences (BPS) proposers should review [ROSES-2025 E.1 Biological and Physical Sciences Research Program Overview](#) for general context on focus areas of BPS, though not all areas of E.1 are eligible for this FINESST solicitation. BPS seeks advances in the biological and physical sciences through space-relevant research, to enable space exploration and pioneer scientific discovery. Please see the NASA [Task Book](#) for present and past BPS research projects. In September 2023, the

National Academies released “[Thriving in Space: Ensuring the Future of Biological and Physical Sciences Research: A Decadal Survey for 2023-2032](#)” which provides guidance for the BPS program, and BPS released the [Decadal Science Road Map \(Version 2.2\)](#) in February 2026.

Investigations submitted to BPS FINESST-25 must be responsive and relevant to one of the topic areas described below, which are Quantum Leaps and Space Crops. Proposals that do not demonstrate relevance shall be returned without review for noncompliance. Proposals shall indicate the selected topic during NSPIRES submission as a response to the Program Specific Data questions. The proposal must describe how the proposed work is relevant to the selected topic.

- Quantum Leaps: This topic seeks proposals for theoretical and/or ground-based experimental research using quantum technologies that will support the development of future space-based experiments to study fundamental physics. Ultimately, the program’s objective is to find and develop opportunities to make transformative, paradigm-shifting advances in physics through space-based experiments. This includes theoretical studies and/or quantum sensor concepts that would search for local signatures of dark matter, dark energy, or test the foundations of fundamental physics such as quantum science and general relativity. Proposals must clearly describe how the proposed work enables research utilizing the unique space environment. Gravitational wave detection is not part of this portfolio, therefore, proposals in this area will be declined for noncompliance.
- Space Crops: This topic solicits research that will identify specific crop phenotypes conducive to optimizing space farming, and/or will elucidate the mechanisms by which crops attain such beneficial phenotypes. Applications to this topic may include studies that will focus on the production or identification of crop cultivars with phenotypes that increase their fitness for use in space farming, or studies that will elucidate the molecular/biochemical pathways responsible for producing such phenotypes. To be responsive to this topic, applicants must clearly identify which space-relevant stressor(s) they are examining in their proposed work and provide a justification for their choice of model crop system(s) selected for the work. For mechanistic studies, applicants must also provide a justification as to why their chosen phenotype(s) is/are relevant to space farming. PLEASE NOTE: Proposals submitted on this topic shall be limited to the use of edible crops for space exploration that can either supplement crew diet (e.g., fruiting crops and leafy greens) or meet the high caloric demands of human beings during exploration missions. Proposals submitted to this topic that involve non-crop plant models, including *Arabidopsis thaliana*, will be declined without review.

2.6 Science Activation and Citizen Science

Proposals in the Science Activation research areas are not solicited this year.

Citizen Science (also known as participatory science) must be aligned and submitted to a research program described 2.1-2.5. No other types of citizen science proposals are

invited. For that reason, there is no “create” proposal button/function for citizen science offered on the NSPIRES page for FINESST-25.

3. Additional Information on ROSES Other Cross-Division Research Programs

FINESST primarily serves as a joint notice of funding opportunity for the SMD research areas listed in [Section 2](#). Proposers must pick one of the participating FINESST areas (listed in 2.1-2.5) when starting a proposal. Thus, a proposal relevant to a cross-divisional program should be submitted to the FINESST participating Divisions most closely aligned with the specific nature of the proposal.

4. FINESST Program Eligibility

A principal investigator (PI) may submit one or more FINESST proposals, but a student shall be named as a Future Investigator (FI) on only one FINESST proposal.

Since there are many graduate degree types that are earth and space science or technology related, FINESST does not limit eligibility based on study discipline or degree type. An eligible FI is a person that, by the proposal due date:

- has applied to, or
- has been admitted to, or
- is enrolled as a graduate student, i.e., a Master's or Ph.D. degree student, or both, at an eligible, accredited U.S. university located within the United States, its territories or possessions, or the Commonwealth of Puerto Rico.

FIs who previously proposed to, but are not funded by, a prior FINESST or any another NASA opportunity such as the NASA Earth and Space Sciences Fellowship (NESSF), the NASA Space Technology Graduate Research Opportunities (NSTGRO) etc., are eligible. FIs who previously proposed to FINESST, were selected and declined the NASA funding also are eligible.

FIs who are applying concurrently for NSTRGO, the National Science Foundation's Graduate Research Fellowship (GRF), or any other federal funding, must list those proposals in the current and pending section.

Past or currently funded FIs, including those who were a successor FI to the original student, are eligible to apply but they are subject to budget limitations.

If the institution of higher education is willing to submit the research proposal for an FI 1) who is not yet at the university, 2) who is NOT a U.S. citizen or permanent resident, or 3) both 1 and 2, then those students are eligible. International students, defined as individuals with 1) a U.S. visa or with temporary protected status, 2) who are enrolled at a U.S. university, and 3) residing in the U.S. are FI-eligible only through the university where they are enrolled.

The PI often is the FI's mentor and holistically supports the FI's research and professional development. The mentor should be shown as a PI or Co-I on the NSPIRES cover page. Unless the submitting institution has a requirement, NASA has no requirement that the mentor be at the proposing institution. NASA does not advise on or assist in identifying who should be the PI or mentor.

NASA civil servants may not be the FI. NASA civil servants/contractors may serve as mentors when they are listed on the proposal's cover page, see [Section 12.6](#).

Most commonly, a university will submit the proposal. However, other institutions that may receive a grant may submit the proposal when they have a relationship with the accredited U.S. higher education institution where the FI is or will be enrolled. In such a case, provide evidence from the accredited U.S. education institution of the student's enrollment/good standing as described in Section 5.1.2.4 "Statements, Letters, and Facility, Equipment, and Other Resources".

NASA Centers and other Federal entities that do not grant degrees are not eligible institutions for FINESST awards. Degree-granting Federal entities that cannot accept federal financial assistance, that is a grant, also are not eligible.

All team members must be listed on the NSPIRES cover page and confirm their participation online so that NASA may manage organizational conflict of interest during peer review.

4.1 International Traffic in Arms Regulations, Export Administration Regulation, Foreign Institutions, and the People's Republic of China

Participation by non-U.S. organizations is welcome only on a "no-exchange-of-funds" basis; for details, see [ROSES FAQ #14](#) and the most recent NASA Grant and Cooperative Agreement Manual (GCAM) located at <https://www.nasa.gov/grants-policy-and-compliance-team/#Regulations>.

FINESST primarily supports fundamental and foundational research and/or technology development projects that normally are not subject to export control. Should the FI's proposed research project fall under International Traffic in Arms Regulations (ITAR) or Export Administration Regulations (EAR), then only U.S. persons may be the PI and FI. Parts of any proposal that contains ITAR material must be identified as instructed in Sections 16.8 and 16.9 of the GCAM. If an FI thinks or doesn't know if ITAR/EAR is an issue, talk to your PI and AOR. The Authorized Organization Representative (AOR) or sponsored programs office will be able to provide information about any EAR and ITAR requirements.

When the NSPIRES Cover Page asks whether the proposal contains information or data subject to U.S. export control (e.g., EAR and ITAR) and the answer is "yes," then add a front page that clearly indicates e.g., page number, section, figure or other parts of the proposal that contain export control information. This page does not count against the page limit.

Proposals involving bilateral participation, collaboration, or coordination in any way with People's Republic of China (PRC) or any PRC-owned company, whether funded or not, shall be ineligible for award. For more information, please see the [ROSES PRC FAQ](#).

Proposers whose research might occur outside of the U.S. or with organizations outside the U.S. should see Section 12, Ancillary Information for Proposers, regarding "Foreign Participation."

4.2 Data Limitations and Requirements

Data must be within the eligibility scope set by the Division(s) Research Program(s) described in Section 2. This may include 1) fee-free data, 2) data available for purchase, e.g., commercial, and 3) data to be collected as part of the proposed activity. Proposing to use data that has not yet 1) been collected or 2) made public (see below) is not prohibited but is a risk.

For example, future data may come from airborne campaigns, field campaigns, fieldwork, CubeSats, International Space Station experiments, ground-based observations, data being collected by non-NASA activities, etc. If a proposal depends in any way upon data that has not yet been collected, then the proposal's Science/Technical/Management (S/T/M) section must explain 1) risks to the overall project due to the collection of the data and 2) any steps to be taken to mitigate such risks. The S/T/M should state whether the future data is necessary to successfully complete the proposed objectives.

If a project depends completely on not-yet-acquired data, then that may 1) be noted as a proposal weakness, and 2) prevent SMD from recommending that proposal for funding even when it is otherwise highly rated.

Normally, data necessary for a FINESST project is available to the public at least 30 days prior to the proposal due date. For example, [NASA mission](#) data necessary for the proposed work must be available in a publicly accessible [NASA science data repository](#) or from other sources including other federal and private agencies or international missions may be used 1) if relevant to SMD and 2) publicly available at least 30 days prior to the proposal due date. Future data is not prohibited, but it carries risk. If a proposal depends on data that has been collected but not yet made public 30 days prior to submission, then the S/T/M must explain 1) the data accessibility risks and 2) any steps to be taken to mitigate such risks. If you have questions about whether data is eligible, please write to the most appropriate point of contact listed in Section 11.

The proposal's Open Science and Data Management Plan (OSDMP) must describe the plan to make public 1) any data collected and 2) any data product generated from existing data.

5. Proposal Preparation and Submission

In addition to the NSPIRES web interface "cover pages", proposals are made up of two required files: 1. The anonymized technical proposal document (see 5.1.1), 2. The Expertise and Resources (E&R) not anonymized document (see 5.1.2), and sometimes a third optional high-end computing appendix (see 5.1.2.7). All three are separately uploaded PDF files. The first document, the technical proposal, must be anonymized for dual-anonymous peer review (DAPR), see [Section 5.2](#).

At minimum, proposals will consist of two files with these sections:

1. Anonymized Technical Proposal Document (DAPR compliant)
 - a. Science/Technical/Management (S/T/M) Section
 - b. Open Science and Data Management Plan (OSDMP)
 - c. Mentoring Plan

2. Expertise and Resources (E&R) Not Anonymized Document
 - a. Research Readiness Statement for the Future Investigator (FI)
 - b. Biosketch (see link to template in Section 5.1.2.2)
 - c. Current and Pending Support (see link to template in Section 5.1.2.3)
 - d. Statements, Letters, and Facility, Equipment, and Other Resources
 - e. Acknowledgements
 - f. Budget and Narrative

Proposals must be formatted for DAPR, see [Section 5.2](#). All proposals must be submitted in electronic format via NSPIRES or Grants.gov. When creating the proposal, the proposer must choose a division (see Section 2) to which the proposal will be submitted.

The FI should be listed on the cover page in Section VI as a Team Member (select "Graduate/Undergraduate Student" as the FI's "Team Member Role").

The main body text of proposals and captions must use a font of no more than 15 characters (including spaces) per horizontal inch (typical of 12-point Times New Roman) and no more than 5.5 lines per vertical inch (i.e., single-spaced). There must be at least one-inch margins on all sides (excluding the NASA Biosketch and Current and Pending templates), and the proposal must be sized for U.S. letter size (8.5x11) paper. In accordance with [Table 1 of ROSES-2025](#), no technical content may be put in the margins; page numbers and anonymous disclaimers, e.g., "this page contains proprietary materials/data" are permitted. Proposals deemed non-compliant with respect to formatting requirements may be returned without review.

5.1 Content of a FINESST Proposal

The proposal will be composed of the NSPIRES "cover pages", and two or three separately uploaded PDF files:

1. An anonymized technical proposal PDF containing the components described in Section 5.1.1, below,
2. The non-anonymized "Expertise and Resources Not Anonymized" PDF containing the components described in Section 5.1.2, and
3. The optional non-anonymized HEC Appendix described in Section 5.1.2.7.

No additional components or files are permitted.

The NSPIRES "cover page" is created automatically from information that the proposers put into the NSPIRES web forms. Proposers must ensure that the Project Summary, as part of the cover page, is compliant with the DAPR guidelines. Other sections do not need to be anonymized (see Section 4.2 below).

All team members must be listed on the NSPIRES cover page. A proposal cannot be submitted if any listed team member, including unfunded collaborators, does not log into NSPIRES and confirm their role on the proposal. For information on the confirmation process please see this [NSPIRES help page](#).

5.1.1 Anonymized Technical Proposal Document

5.1.1.1 Science/Technical/Management Section – ANONYMIZED

The Science/Technical/Management (S/T/M) section of the proposal describes the proposed research project and should be self-contained without relying on other sections of the proposal. Proposers may include figures and tables as appropriate but ensure the captions for those are DAPR-compliant as well. The S/T/M section, excluding citations, may total no more than six (6) pages. The S/T/M section must be DAPR-compliant, and it should include the following elements:

- A well-defined problem with a justification of its scientific significance and a detailed approach for its resolution.
- A statement describing the relevance of the proposed work to the appropriate SMD Division and a program within that division. If the research is relevant to more than one division/program, please identify the other division(s).
- A description of the approach to be taken to address the problem. A schedule for the proposed project describing anticipated accomplishments and major milestones, including planned publications. In cases when the PI already has an ongoing research award from NASA, the research proposed under FINESST may address a similar topic, but the proposal must make clear, anonymously, how the proposed research goes beyond what NASA has already funded or recommended for potential funding.

5.1.1.2 References – ANONYMIZED

References and/or endnotes must directly follow the S/T/M section and are not included in the S/T/M section's 6-page limit. In keeping with the DAPR requirements (see Section 5.2 below), reference callouts in the text (i.e., the callouts in the text that refer to a cited source) must be numerical (e.g. [1], [2], etc.) rather than using author's names.

Do not include references to documents unavailable to reviewers, see [ROSES FAQ19](#). URLs are permitted in the references section, but reviewers are not obligated to follow any such links in the conduct of their evaluation. Do not use the reference section to introduce new/additional information about the proposed investigation that belongs in a page-limited Section such as the S/T/M.

5.1.1.3 Open Science and Data Management Plan – ANONYMIZED

Proposals must include an anonymized Open Science and Data Management Plan (OSDMP) of up to two pages that describes how data, data products, publications and software created will be made public (see Section 2 of [ROSES-2025 F.1 Cross Division Research Overview](#) and the [SMD Open-Source Science Guidance](#) and templates). The OSDMP must answer the following questions:

- a. What are the data types, volumes, formats, and data standards, where relevant?
- b. In what repository do the proposers intend to make these data available?
- c. When will these data be made available?
- d. Who will do the archiving and what experience do they have with this kind of data, archive, etc.?
- e. How will software be developed and released (if applicable)?

A common DAPR mistake is citing a specific institution's repository; please remember to include general statements to meet DAPR requirements (e.g., "will be archived at the PI/FI institution's repository").

Regardless of what the OSDMP submitted with the proposal says, grantees must still meet the mandatory minimum requirements that:

- a. As-accepted manuscript versions of publications that derive from ROSES awards must be publicly available at the time of publication;
- b. Data and software developed using ROSES funding in support of a peer-reviewed publication shall be made publicly available at the time of publication;
- c. Scientifically useful data and software developed during the award that was not already published must be made publicly available by the end of the award; and
- d. To be eligible to receive funding, PIs, FI, and Co-Is must provide their digital persistent identifier (e.g., ORCID) via NSPIRES under Account Management → Personal Profile. See the section on "Persistent Identifiers for Investigators" in the [SMD Open-Source Science Guidance](#).

5.1.1.4 Mentoring Plan or Agreement – ANONYMIZED

Proposals must include an anonymized Mentoring Plan or Agreement. This section should not exceed two pages. The Mentoring Plan/Agreement's purpose is to provide the FI with a holistic plan for developing skills and acquiring knowledge and experience necessary to complete the research project and/or personal professional development. This mentoring plan should not need to restate information provided in response to Sections 5.1.1.1 - 5.1.1.4. Due to DAPR, the mentoring plan must not be signed. This plan is reviewed under the Scientific Merit criterion.

The FI and mentor(s) should prepare this agreement together. It may include more than one mentor; however, having additional mentors does not extend the page limit. Non-PI mentors do not have to be at the submitting institution. It is optional to include mentors beyond the PI, but if they are named, they must be added to the NSPIRES cover page as team members and must confirm their participation via NSPIRES.

5.1.2. Expertise and Resources Not Anonymized Document

5.1.2.1 Research Readiness Statement – NOT ANONYMIZED – Limit 1 page

A Research Readiness Statement (RRS) of up to one page authored by the FI must be included in the separate "Expertise and Resources Not Anonymized" document. The RRS must include the following:

- a. State and describe how the FI's undergraduate and/or graduate degree program and interactions with the mentor(s) prepare, or will prepare, the FI for the proposed research. Some possible questions to address include (but are not limited to): has the FI's past, current, and/or planned coursework and self-directed study given the FI a good foundational understanding of the general subject area related to the proposed research? If a particular computer programming language, statistical analysis tool, experimental technique is

- required for the proposed project, is the FI proficient or do they have a plan to become proficient?
- b. Provide a graduate study timeline that states i) the degree type (Ph.D., Master's, both, or other type of graduate degree, e.g., M.D.); ii) the subject area, iii) how long the FI has been (or if not yet admitted, expects to be) enrolled in the program, and iv) the estimated graduation month and year.
 - c. State and describe other experiences and/or self-directed learning activities that are relevant to the proposed research. This includes, but is not limited to, short courses offered at conferences, summer/winter schools, independent research projects, internships, work experience, volunteer experience, or teaching experience.

5.1.2.2 Biosketch – NOT ANONYMIZED – No page limit

The proposal must provide separate biosketches for the PI and FI, to be included in the separate "Expertise and Resources Not Anonymized" document. There is no page limit. A biosketch is optional for any Co-I(s) or collaborator who is also a mentor. Do not provide a biosketch for team members who are non-mentors. Proposers are required to use the [NASA Grants Policy-provided template for the Biographical Sketch](#) (docx). If the NASA template is not used or if NASA updates the templates with new certification requirements before an award is made, the NASA Shared Services Center (NSSC) will contact proposers to provide updated biosketches and that will delay the funding process.

NOTE: It is optional to watch NASA's Grants Policy and Compliance Team's video that explains NASA's [Biographical Sketch and Current and Pending Support Disclosure Requirements](#).

5.1.2.3 Current and Pending Support – NOT ANONYMIZED – No page limit

All PIs and FIs must provide, in the separate "Expertise and Resources Not Anonymized" document, a list of Current and Pending (C&P) support that identifies any current and potential funding external-to-the-proposing organization, e.g., from U.S. federal, U.S. non-federal, and non-U.S. sources such as any active applications for grants, fellowships etc., particularly those that have overlap with the proposed work.. Proposers should use only the [NASA Grants Policy-provided template for Current and Pending](#) (docx).

Even if the FI and/or PI have no C&P other than the FINESST proposal to report, they must use NASA's C&P template.

NOTE: As of the FINESST release date, NASA does not accept C&Ps or Biosketches generated by SciENCv. If NASA becomes a SciENCv participating agency before the FINESST due date, only then may SciENCv be used.

5.1.2.4 Statements, Letters, and Facility, Equipment, and Other Resources – NOT ANONYMIZED – No page limit

As indicated in the Section 10.9 of the GCAM ("Facilities, Equipment, and Other Resources"), applicants are required to submit a technical narrative for facilities, equipment, and other resources (F&E) that describes any special F&E that are required to complete the proposed project. F&E must be included in the separate "Expertise and

Resources Not Anonymized" document. See Section IV(e) "Demonstration of Access to Required Facility" of the ROSES Summary of Solicitation regarding the use of letters of "Resource Support" to demonstrate that a facility or resource is available for the proposed use. If the proposing team has regular access to a facility or resource, then no such letter is needed.

Do not add Statements of Commitment from any team member who acknowledges commitment via NSPIRES; confirmation of participation via NSPIRES is sufficient. Statements of Commitment are only required when commitment cannot be made via NSPIRES, such as when a proposer is using Grants.gov.

Any special documentation, e.g., from a non-profit that is not an education organization demonstrating that the proposed FI is enrolled/in good standing at an eligible degree program at a university, may be included in this section.

5.1.2.5 Acknowledgements - NOT ANONYMIZED – Limit 150 words

An acknowledgement statement of up to 150 words that affirms that the FI was the primary author for the proposal must be included in the separate "Expertise and Resources Not Anonymized" document. NASA discourages the unacknowledged inclusion of any content in proposal materials or award reports that is not the creative product of the proposal team (e.g. obtained through generative AI tools). For more information see [ROSES FAQ#32](#).

5.1.2.6 Budget and Narrative – NOT ANONYMIZED – No page limit

While the NSPIRES cover page asks for summarized budget data, it is necessary to include a budget justification within the proposal. FINESST awards are subject to the normal government and NASA policies regarding allowable costs, e.g., see 12.11 and 12.12.

The budget and budget narrative must be included in the "Expertise and Resources Not Anonymized" PDF. There is no page limit, but it normally does not exceed two pages. Unlike other ROSES programs, **FINESST does not request or allow a separate "Total Budget" file.**

Proposers may request FI funding in ways that comply with 2 CFR 200 and the proposing organization's written policies, such as but not limited to:

- As a direct labor cost;
- As a scholarship or other student aid that shall comply with the requirements in 2 CFR 200.466, Scholarships and student aid costs; or
- As a participant support cost as defined in 2 CFR 200.1, Definitions.

Per the definition of "Modified Total Direct Costs" in [2 CFR § 200.1](#), Definitions, facilities and administrative (F&A) costs, sometimes called indirect costs, are not permitted for scholarship awards.

Per § 200.456 Participant support costs: The classification of items as participant support costs must be documented in the recipient's or subrecipient's written policies and procedures and treated consistently across all Federal awards.

FINESST awards are intended to support only student projects and research. Request no salary, travel, or other costs for the PIs, Co-Is, or Collaborators.

The FINESST grant may be for up to three years in duration, contingent upon availability of funds and satisfactory performance as demonstrated through the annual progress report. Not all projects require three years. Proposers should request the time needed.

The start date should be no earlier than January 2027 and no later than one year after the proposal due date. NASA reserves the right to change the requested start date/end date for the award's period of performance (POP). Proposers should choose a POP that makes sense for their project and complies with their organization's written policies. Proposers should talk to their Authorized Organization Representative (AOR) or sponsored research office about whether their organization will allow pre-award costs as this may impact the viability of a start date.

The total amount proposed may not exceed \$50,000 per budget year for all costs combined. Each proposal budget period may be a calendar year or some other logical period, i.e., academic year, summer-only, etc.

The budget narrative must provide justifications of the requested amount in each category. When requesting participant support costs, the FI costs should be entered on the NSPIRES cover pages under letter E. Direct Costs-Participant/Trainee Support Cost. NSPIRES listed subcategories are: 1) Tuition/Fees/Health Insurance, 2) Stipends, 3) Travel, 4) Subsistence, and 5) Other. If a proposal is not requesting participant support costs, then the items under E should be left blank.

The budget narratives must specify whether the institution is treating the FI as 1) an employee or 2) a participant; 3) a scholarship recipient, or 4) some other cost category, e.g. consultant or contractor, as this determines what costs are reasonable, allocable, and allowable, including overhead, indirect or F&A.

Proposed budget/award size restrictions on students who have had prior FINESST or NESSF funding:

- If an FI was previously a named student on an awarded FINESST or NESSF grant as originally submitted, the new proposal submitted to this program element may not request support such that the time funded from both proposals exceeds 36 months. For example, if an FI was awarded a twelve-month FINESST grant for master's research, that FI may propose for up to 24 months of FINESST support for Ph.D. research but may not propose 36 months of support.
- If an FI was supported via a NESSF or FINESST grant where they were not listed as the original named student on the award – most commonly in the case where a PI requested that a new student be allowed to use funds remaining on a FINESST or NESSF grant originally awarded to a different student – the FI may request a full 36 months.

The submitted budget is preliminary and subject to negotiation. Typically, before award the NASA Shared Services Center asks proposers to verify the start date and budget, and if applicable, provide a revised budget.

5.1.2.7 *Optional High-End Computing Appendix – NOT ANONYMIZED No page limit*

The High-End Computing ([HEC](#)) program provides a specialized computational infrastructure to support NASA's research community. Proposers to FINESST may apply for HEC resources to support their research by submitting a request to the HEC system and uploading the request form as a separate PDF file ("Optional HEC request"). Do not include this request form in either the anonymized main proposal PDF file or the "Expertise and Resources Not Anonymized" document. See 12.15-12.19 for details on how to pursue this option.

5.2 Preparing Proposals for Dual-Anonymous Peer Review

Proposals submitted to this program will be evaluated using a dual-anonymous peer review (DAPR) process in which not only are proposers unaware of the identity of the reviewers, but the reviewers are not provided with explicit knowledge of the identities of the proposing team during the evaluation of the proposal. The overarching objective of dual-anonymous peer review is to reduce unconscious bias in the evaluation of the proposal.

To implement dual-anonymous peer review, reviewers may not see any specific information that reveals the identity of the proposers or the proposing institution(s).

The forms filled out on the NSPIRES web pages with Proposal Summary, Budget, Proposal Team and Program Specific and Business Data known as the NSPIRES "cover pages" will be partly hidden for the peer reviewers.

The Proposal Summary, called the Project Summary in Section VII of the NSPIRES cover pages, must be anonymized. Other sections of the NSPIRES cover page should be completed as normal. NSPIRES will automatically redact any identifying information from other sections of the system-generated cover pages.

The main proposal document (see [Section 5.1.1](#)) must be anonymized in accordance with the guidelines provided. More detailed instructions together with examples for anonymizing your proposal are provided in, "Guidelines for Proposers to ROSES Dual-Anonymous Peer Review Programs" under other documents on the [FINESST NSPIRES page](#), and [Section V\(b\)i](#) of the Summary of Solicitation

Proposers must upload a second, separate file "Expertise and Resources Not Anonymized" document, that contains all the personal (and organizational) identifying information.

Below is a list of the proposal anonymized components that must be included in a single PDF file. Remember to make sure that all PDF bookmarks and document properties, e.g., footers and headers, are properly anonymized:

ANONYMIZED Item / Page Limit	Requirement
Science-Technical-Management (S/T/M) section of proposal / Up to 6 pages	The S/T/M section must be anonymized per the instructions in the document, "Guidelines for Proposers to ROSES DAPR Programs" (see link on NSPIRES page for program element).

	Reference callouts in the proposal text must be in numerical format (e.g. [1], [2], etc.).
References / As necessary	Follows the S/T/M Section but is not included in the page limit for the S/T/M section. Citations should follow DAPR guidelines. See Section V(b)i of the Summary of Solicitation.
Open Science and Data Management Plan / Up to 2 pages	The Open Science and Data Management Plan must be anonymized. See Section 5.1.1.3.
Mentoring Plan or Agreement/ Up to 2 Pages	The Mentoring Plan must be anonymized. See Section 5.1.1.4.

A summary of the proposal's non-anonymized components, uploaded as a separate document in NSPIRES (choose Attachment Type = "Expertise and Resources Not Anonymized") is listed below:

NOT ANONYMIZED Item / Page Limit	Requirement
Research Readiness Statement / Up to 1 page	Do not include in the main anonymized proposal document. It must be included in the separate "Expertise and Resources Not Anonymized" document.
Biosketch / As needed	Do not include in the main anonymized proposal document. Include in separate "Expertise and Resources Not Anonymized" document.
Current and Pending Support / As needed	Do not include in the main anonymized proposal document. Include in separate "Expertise and Resources Not Anonymized" document.
Statements, Letters, and Facility, Equipment, and Other Resources / As needed	Do not include in the main anonymized proposal document. Make sure to provide a list of all team members, their roles, institutional affiliations, expertise, and contributions to the work. Include in separate "Expertise and Resources Not Anonymized" document.
Acknowledgements /150 words	Do not include in the main anonymized proposal document. Include in separate "Expertise and Resources Not Anonymized" document.
Budget and Narrative / Typically 2 pages	Do not include in the main anonymized proposal document. Include in separate "Expertise and Resources Not Anonymized" document.

Optional High End Computing Request is a separate (third) PDF document.

Item	Requirement
Optional High End Computing Request	See Sections 12.15 – 12.19. Notes: A) Some HEC requests must be included in the budget.

	B) The S/T/M section must provide an anonymized outline of the HEC computing resources requested in the proposal, or as a planned future request.
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5.3 Late Proposals

Proposals must be submitted electronically by 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on the due date given in Tables [2](#) and [3](#) of ROSES. NSPIRES generates automatically an email acknowledgement when any proposal is submitted.

NSPIRES marks FINESST proposals submitted after the due date or deadline as "late". Late proposals will be handled in accordance with the [SMD Policy on Late Proposals](#). SMD does not pre-approve the submission of a late proposal. The decision to submit a late proposal is solely that of the proposer, and it is then NASA's decision whether to accept it or not. Proposals not submitted by the due date may be returned without review. The FINESST program scientists/administrators are not empowered to authorize the submission of a late proposal.

When the FINESST solicitation completely shuts down on NSPIRES, the proposer is prevented from finishing a submission.

6. Proposal Evaluation

6.1 Compliance Check

SMD team members may conduct a compliance/relevance check at any time during the process, most commonly prior to peer review. Checks may include verifying that the proposal includes all required parts, meets formatting requirements, including the use of NASA's Biosketch and Current and Pending Templates, and whether a) proposal summary, called a project summary, on the NSPIRES cover page and b) the main proposal (including S/T/M section, OSDMP, and mentoring plan) satisfy DAPR requirements.

Proposals that do not meet page length, formatting, and/or other requirements, and/or research scope is beyond the reviewing division's specifications (see [Section 2](#)), may be returned without peer review.

If SMD staff believe that a proposal has been submitted to the wrong division, then the proposer may be given the opportunity to have their proposal moved to another SMD division or shared with another SMD division for additional review when it is practical to do so.

Do not include academic transcripts or letters of recommendation anywhere within the proposal.

Proposals containing unsolicited appendices or attachments may be returned without review.

6.2 Review

The review process includes an assessment of a proposal's strengths and weaknesses for each review criterion. The anonymous sections will be peer-reviewed first. After the

initial evaluation, the Not Anonymized section of the proposal will be evaluated according to each division's evaluation procedure.

The default definitions of evaluation criteria are given in Section 12.3.1 of the [GCAM](#), applied as described in Section V of the ROSES Summary of Solicitation, and are slightly modified as described below.

The criteria for evaluation of FINESST proposals are scientific merit, relevance, research readiness, and Cost reasonableness, see Section 6.2.1-6.2.4 below. The first two criteria will be applied to the anonymized portions of the proposal. Research readiness and cost reasonableness will be based on the separately uploaded "Expertise and Resources Not Anonymized" document.

6.2.1 Scientific Merit Criterion

Assessment of the merit includes:

1. The compelling nature of the research topic.
2. The exhibited depth of understanding of the research topic.
3. The expected impact of the research, should it succeed.
4. The feasibility of the proposed research plan, including the availability of resources for successful completion of the project.
5. The robustness of the research plan to anticipated setbacks.
6. The adequacy of the OSDMP or of the explanation for why an OSDMP is not provided/required.
7. The adequacy of the PI-FI Mentoring Plan/Agreement.

6.2.2 Relevance Criterion

Assessment of the relevance will be based on the extent to which the proposed addresses:

- Objectives as described in Section 2: Division Research Overviews.
- Whether and how well the proposal describes the relevance of the proposed work to the division(s) to which it was submitted.

6.2.3 Research Readiness Criterion

The Research Readiness criterion focuses on how the FI's research design and approach correlate with their actual research skills/capabilities as described in the:

- FI's research readiness statement
- The FI's Biosketch.
- The PI's Biosketch.

Assessment of the research readiness may include:

- Demonstration of a good understanding of the general subject area and background science related to the proposed research
- FI's involvement in any activities that make them particularly capable of conducting the proposed research.
- Whether the PI and other research mentor(s), if applicable, possess qualifications suited for the proposed research project.

6.2.4 Cost Reasonableness Criterion

Reviewers may be asked to comment on whether the requested costs appear sufficient to implement the project or whether the requested budget exceeds the maximum annual \$50,000 allotment, or the total budget for the entire performance period.

7. Award Information and Restrictions

The start date for new awards normally is no earlier than January 2027 and no later than one year after the proposal due date (See Section 11 for specific dates).

Students funded by a FINESST grant may receive funding from other sources for any expenses not covered by this award.

The maximum amount of a FINESST award is \$50,000 per 12-months and up to \$150,000 total for a maximum period of performance of up to 36 months, not including any hiatus or leave without stipend or other form of direct compensation to the FI, if applicable, or any no cost extension (NCE).

The student compensation or stipend, when applicable and possible, should be comparable with the institution's prevailing policies and practices. The written policies of the awardee institutions and the most current 2 CFR 200 Cost Principles take precedence at the time of the award. It is possible that a student may be funded as an employee or a consultant or some other direct cost category using NASA funds.

FIs may take a hiatus to pursue other activities such as internships, family leave, military leave, etc. When a student is on hiatus for more than three months, the student will not receive a FINESST stipend, and the institution shall not draw down/spend the FINESST stipend funds during the FI's hiatus. If the compensation paid to the FI is not a stipend but is paid as salary or some other type of direct cost, then the awarded institution's written policies related to hiatus take precedence.

During the period that a FINESST proposal is under consideration or during the period of performance of a FINESST grant, the funded institution's Authorized Organization Representative (AOR) must inform NASA if the student has accepted any Federal or non-Federal fellowship or traineeship that 1) provides stipend and other costs, e.g., tuition that overlap with the FINESST award, and 2) is longer than three months in duration. In an instance when SMD recommends such a proposal to receive a FINESST grant, NASA may require a revised budget before award, and, if appropriate, a revised proposal for any active award to ensure that the FI can devote sufficient time to the FINESST research.

A PI may have FINESST and other (e.g., ROSES, NSF, DoD) proposals with overlapping scope of work submitted at the same time. In this case, the PI should acknowledge in the budget justification or note in the C&P that funds are requested elsewhere. If accepting a FINESST grant, the PI must alert the FINESST technical officer of any overlap so that budget negotiations/adjustments may ensue. NASA will not fund duplicative work.

8. Reporting Requirements

In accordance with any award terms and conditions provided by the NSSC at the time of award, a progress report is due no later than 60 days prior to the anniversary date of the

award. If an adequate progress report is not received, then the NSSC will not send funds. For details see [Section 13.4](#).

9. Collection of Demographic Information

NASA requests and collects demographic data from NSPIRES users for the purpose of analyzing demographic differences associated with its award processes. Information collected will include sex, race, ethnicity, and disability status. Submission of the information is voluntary, confidential, and is not a precondition of award.

10. Points of Contact and Frequently Asked Questions

The participating SMD funding organizations comprise the FINESST Team membership. Email questions to the relevant division(s) Funding POC(s) listed in Section 11 and HQ-FINESST@mail.nasa.gov.

11. Summary of Key Information

Expected annual program budget for new awards	No dedicated budget. Proposals will be funded by the relevant SMD Division or program
Number of new awards pending adequate proposals of merit	Awards by division may range from 1 to ~60.
Maximum duration of awards	3 years and see Section 6
Due date for Notice of Intent to propose (NOI)	Not Applicable. Notices of Intent are not requested/accepted for this program element
Due date for proposals	Proposals may be submitted at any time until 11:59 pm Eastern Time on the due date given in Tables 2 and 3 of ROSES
Planning date for start of investigation	No earlier than January and no later than one year after the proposal due date. Proposers may request an earlier start date, subject to NASA's 90-day pre-award spending policy (section 5.1.2.6).
Page limit for the central Science/Technical/Management section of proposal	6 pages; see also Section 5.1 of this program element
Instructions for proposal preparation	See Section 5.
Website and detailed instructions for the submission of proposals via NSPIRES	https://nspires.nasaprs.com See NSPIRES Online Help (help desk available at nspires-help@nasaprs.com or (202) 479-9376)
Website for submission of proposal via Grants.gov	https://www.grants.gov/ (help desk available at support@grants.gov or (800) 518-4726)

Funding opportunity number for downloading a proposal package from Grants.gov	NNH25ZDA001N-FINESST
Coordinating Points of Contact	HQ-FINESST Team HQ-FINESST@mail.nasa.gov
Funding Points of Contact	FINESST Program Scientists by funding organization: Earth Science: yaitza.luna-cruz@nasa.gov cynthia.r.hall@nasa.gov Planetary Science: Nick Lang & Henry Throop Shared Email: HQ-PSDFINESST@mail.nasa.gov Astrophysics: antonino.cucchiara@nasa.gov roopesh.ojha@nasa.gov Heliophysics: jared.m.bell@nasa.gov Biological & Physical Science: ursula.m.koniges@nasa.gov

12. Ancillary Information for Proposers

12.1 The Structure of ROSES and its Relationship to Other Guidance

A "program element" in ROSES, such as F.5 FINESST, may contain specific requirements that supersede the common requirements found in the *ROSES Summary of Solicitation* and the requirements for all NASA solicitations in the [NASA Grant and Cooperative Agreement Manual \(GCAM\) –March 2025 \(PDF\)](#) or a newer GCAM at <https://www.nasa.gov/grants-policy-and-compliance-team/#Regulations>. The order of precedence is the following: F.5 FINESST takes precedence, followed by F.1 Cross Division Research Overview or a Division-specific overview A.1 through E.1, followed by the *ROSES Summary of Solicitation*, followed by the GCAM. That is, if FINESST tells you to do something different than what ROSES or the GCAM says, do what FINESST tells you to do.

12.2 Foreign Participation

Participation in ROSES-funded research by non-U.S. organizations is welcome on a "no exchange of funds" basis; see [ROSES FAQ #14](#) on this topic and the [GCAM](#). for more information on foreign participation in proposals please see Section III(b) of the [ROSES Summary of Solicitation](#).

12.3 When a non-degree-granting institution proposes an FI, what kind of “evidence” is SMD looking for “from the accredited U.S. education institution of the student’s enrollment/good standing in an eligible degree program?”

This is administrative requirement, not an endorsement or recommendation. Do not include student transcripts. Canned letters from a qualified source included in the Statements, Letters, and Facility, Equipment and Other Resources Section 5.1.2.4 is the evidence, i.e., proof that the proposed FI is enrolled/in good standing at an eligible U.S. university.

12.4 What if my proposal is relevant to multiple SMD funding organizations?

Proposal submission requires choosing just one reviewing division/program. However, proposals that are relevant to more than one part of SMD are welcome. If the research is relevant to more than one division/program, we encourage the proposer to contact the divisions point of contact (see Section 11) before submission to receive guidance. When the research is relevant to more than one division/program, please identify the other funder(s) in the abstract on the cover page. In addition, following submission of the proposal and no later than 10 days following the due date, please email HQ-FINESST@mail.nasa.gov using a subject line that states: “FINESST Proposal <insert number> Potential for Multi-Division Review”. If, prior to a proposal’s review, NASA determines that a submitted proposal belongs to a different division entirely, then it may suggest to the proposer that the proposal be reassigned to another division rather than be shared for additional review.

12.5 May I propose to do research that may overlap work previously funded by NASA or work that is currently submitted to NASA and is under review?

In cases when the PI already has an ongoing research award from NASA, the research proposed under FINESST may address a similar topic, but the proposal should make clear that the proposed research does not duplicate the existing award and how the proposed research goes beyond what NASA is already supporting. It is OK if a proposal to another ROSES program and under review has overlap with the proposed FINESST work, but each proposal must be listed in the "Current and Pending Funding" section of the other proposal, and if both are chosen, one or both budgets may be decreased.

12.6 May NASA Civil Servants participate? What about Civil Servants at other agencies?

NASA civil servants (CS) who also have a qualifying student affiliation at an eligible degree-awarding institution may not be proposed as an FI. NASA CS who have questions about their potential FI eligibility options must consult their Center's General Counsel or other qualified Center authority. Non-NASA CS must talk to their own agency legal counsel about whether they can be proposed or serve as FIs. Federal civil servants, contractors, or federal contractor equivalents who are proposing through an eligible institution to serve as PIs shall only use non-NASA email addresses to demonstrate qualifying status at the proposing institution. Civil servants seeking to propose as PIs should seek advice for their agency counsel before committing to a proposal. Civil servants/ federal contractors may serve as mentors when they are listed as a Co-I or collaborator.

12.7 Will there be a Pre-Proposal Teleconference or Webinar? Will it be recorded for those who miss it and available for replay on demand?

Yes, an optional event with the FINESST program scientists will be held via Webex on ~~April~~ **May 28, 2026**, starting at 1pm Eastern Time, 10 am Pacific Time. **[Corrected April 16, 2026]**

Join link:

<https://nasaevents2.webex.com/nasaevents2/j.php?MTID=m46cf23fb418319dd09aba5be75bfcbfd>

Webinar number: 2819 713 4768

Webinar password: Q3Uu37wZr4j (73883799 when dialing from a phone or video system)

Join by phone :

+1-415-527-5035 United States Toll

Access code: 281 971 34768

For TTY-equipped callers or other types of relay services in the United States, no earlier than 15 minutes before the start of the event, call 711 and provide the same join by phone number; the Webinar phone password 73883799, and Access code, 281 971 34768 if prompted.

To preserve anonymity of callers, callers should not disclose their names or institutions. Anonymous questions may be posted to the public at

<https://nasa.cnf.io/sessions/tfw5/#!/dashboard>.

Email HQ-FINESST@mail.nasa.gov with non-public agenda suggestions and questions using "FINESST Webinar" in the email's subject line on or before May 22, 2026. SMD will post the presentation charts no later than 12 p.m. Eastern Time on the conference day under "Other Documents" on [the NSPIRES page for this program element](#).

The FINESST Team expects to establish an accessible location where the event may be replayed on demand. If that happens, then a notice will be posted on [the NSPIRES page for this program element](#) and link will be posted under other documents.

The Earth Science Division will be hosting 2 Office Hours sessions:

- June 23, 2026, 1-2 PM Eastern Time
<https://teams.microsoft.com/meet/271801649791658?p=dBqxtwnVrN4qHhws4s>
- June 24, 2026, 1-2 PM Eastern Time
<https://teams.microsoft.com/meet/271801649791658?p=dBqxtwnVrN4qHhws4s>

12.8 May visa costs be included in the proposal's budget?

Short-term visa costs may be requested only when such costs qualify as "Recruiting costs" per 2 CFR 200.463. For these costs to be directly charged to a FINESST award, however, the budget narrative must demonstrate that the non-U.S. FI:

1. Is critical and necessary for the conduct of the proposed FINESST research;
2. Is allowable under the applicable cost principles;
3. Is consistent with the non-Federal entity's cost accounting practices and non-Federal entity policy; and

4. Meets the definition of “direct cost” as described in the applicable cost principles. For additional information see Subpart E - Cost Principles in 2 CFR 200.

12.9 What is the expected amount of the FI Stipend or other direct compensation IF the standard student compensation is greater than \$50,0000?

In cases where the FINESST \$50,000 is 1) not enough to cover the standard student stipend or other form of compensation or 2) not enough to cover the standard FI costs at the university for a 12-month period, the university may choose to cover expenses from other sources and may show in the proposed budget the amount and source of the cost share. Alternatively, the proposal budget narrative can plan that the FI take a hiatus to work on something funded by a non-FINESST source. Other FI support strategies may be proposed, particularly in cases where the institution treats the FI as an employee, as a consultant, or as a contractor, and not as a participant.

12.10 May the FINESST award amount be put toward other costs like teaching, research travel, conference attendance, equipment, etc.?

Yes, if an FI’s NASA-funded compensation will be zero or less than \$40,000, then the amounts in the other budget categories may be adjusted/exchanged up to \$50,000.

There is a limitation on proposers who request neither stipend nor salary nor other direct compensation, such as tuition, for the FI. Such compensation-free budgets may request only up to \$10,000 annually for travel and other allowable costs, including any allowable indirect. See 12.12 regarding equipment costs. Tuition-only budgets are permitted as long as they comply with the written policies of the proposing institution and do not exceed the annual cap of \$50,000.

Caution: Costs related to an FI’s teaching to further the proposed FINESST research, , may be allowable. If the Department or University sets a teaching requirement as a degree requirement unrelated to the FINESST research, then that is probably not allowable. Talk to your AOR. Remember you may plan in your proposal to take a funding hiatus to meet a teaching requirement. If you don’t make the plan in advance, it may be more complicated and require approval later from the NSSC Grants Officer.

12.11 Are overhead, indirect or F&A costs allowable on a FINESST proposal?

The answer to whether overhead is allowable is case specific-. Sometimes, for administrative convenience, organizations propose FINESST payments to students or on behalf of students via specialized, existing financial systems, such as but not limited to, 1) an employee payroll system or 2) a non-employee or “fellowship” system or 3) some other unique system.

Budgets should specify how the institution treats the FI as: 1) an employee or 2) a participant or 3) some other cost category, e.g., scholarship, consultant or contractor, as this impacts what costs are reasonable, allocable, and allowable, including overhead. Grants Officers (GO) at NASA Shared Services Center, not the FINESST Team, will have the final word on all and any costs in the budget. F&A is allowable when they are included within and do not exceed the annual cap of \$50,000. F&A-only budgets are not permitted.

Reminder: NASA does not permit indirect costs (overhead) to be requested or recovered on participant support costs.

12.12 Are equipment costs allowable on a FINESST proposal?

Yes, with limitations. Equipment may be allowable as long as the costs are \$10,000 or less total for the entire period of performance. For example, if \$10,000 is needed in the first year for equipment costs, then that's all the costs allowed for equipment. The purchase or lease of equipment or services in excess of \$10,000 normally is not permitted through FINESST awards. If an institution's policy permits the purchase of computers, software, digital devices, or services or materials, such as to support mentoring or research activities for the FI or to construct a CubeSat, then these purchases are allowable. Regarding what is and is not allowable or who owns the equipment, e.g., a computer for the FI's use, is left up to the policies at the awarded institution.

Proposers who request these purchase types, or who propose to contract with a service provider for videoconferencing, augmented reality, telepresence robots, communications software/licenses, etc., in lieu of the FI's travel to events or to conduct the research must explain the importance of these purchases/services and how they relate to the success, accessibility, and safety considerations for the research performance in the budget narrative.

12.13 Are the proposal's budget categories strictly fixed, or is there any flexibility?

As long as the total amount requested does not exceed \$50,000 in a 12-month period, then there is flexibility. Talk to your AOR or sponsored programs about how to create a budget that meets your institution's policies and that advances the purpose of the proposed project. Budgets should be designed to support the FI's proposed research and related activities, such as the FI's compensation, professional development, fieldwork, etc. Any costs proposed for award must comply with the cost principles in [2 CFR 200](#), Subpart E. For example, 2 CFR 200 contains information on participant support costs at [§200.456](#); consultants at [§200.459](#), professional service costs; and prizes at [§200.438](#).

12.14 How does SMD decide which proposals are selectable?

The Directors of the participating SMD funding organizations at NASA Headquarters or their designees make decisions about which proposals are selectable or should be declined. Only a Grants Officer (GO) can make an award. SMD Officials judge proposals against the evaluation criteria in Section 6, division objectives, and those specified in this announcement (if any), programmatic considerations, and the available financial resources.

Many proposals will receive reviewer ratings that make them selectable, but are declined for programmatic reasons, e.g., either because the proposed work is redundant with another funded FINESST or other NASA project, or the topic is deemed by NASA to be of lower priority for potential funding. Other programmatic considerations include, but are not limited to, balance across subdisciplines and institution types, technologies, methodologies, data accessibility, etc.

12.15 Are high-end computing (HEC) resources available for FINESST proposals?

SMD provides computational infrastructure to support its research community, managed by the Office of the Chief Science Data Officer NASA Advanced Supercomputing (NAS) Division at Ames Research Center) and the Integrated Earth System Modeling Virtual Institute (IMVI) for the NASA Center for Climate Simulation (NCCS). Proposers must read carefully and follow the guidance in section I(e) NASA High-End Computing (HEC) Resources in [the ROSES-25 Summary of Solicitation](#). Any HEC resources must be justified by completing a request for resources for inclusion with a FINESST proposal.

Proposers to Earth Science requesting resources from the NCCS high-end computing facility must include \$0.09/Standard Billing Unit in their budget per the instructions provided in Section 7.3 of A.1 Earth Science Research Overview. Proposers requesting computing resources from the NAS do not include the estimated costs for high-end computing in their budgets.

12.16 How do I generate a request for HEC Resources?

The PI (not the FI) completes and submits a request in the HEC Request Management System (RMS) at <https://request.hec.nasa.gov/>. The purpose of this step is to inform FINESST reviewers at NASA of your computational needs, and if the FINESST proposal is funded, establish eligibility to use HEC resources. The form includes a written justification of how the requested computational resources would support the investigation as well as a multi-year resource-phasing plan, in annual increments, identifying the computing time and data storage requirements covering the duration of the proposed award period.

RMS uses NASA's Launchpad for authentication, instead of a RMS username and password. Users with existing NASA Credentials can log in using Launchpad as they normally would. New RMS users or returning users without NASA Credentials must register for a NASA Guest Account prior to logging in. New and returning non-credentialed users are cautioned that Launchpad account set up is not instantaneous and may take 72 hours or more.

NOTE: The PI may delegate responsibility for the computational project by identifying the FI as their "Computational PI." The computational PI also MUST register and receive a NASA Guest Account. If the PI wants to identify the FI as Computational PI, they should wait for FINESST results, so that teams whose proposals are declined don't have to do the extra work of setting up guest accounts and changing requests that will never be allocated. Upon notification of award from the NSSC, The PI should send an email to support@hec.nasa.gov providing the name and email of the FI, the HEC request number, and a statement that they would like the FI to serve as the Computational PI.

If you choose not to request HEC resources at the time of proposal submission, another opportunity will be available via RMS after an award is made by a Grants Officer.

About the RMS User Interface: The RMS asks for information in six different sections. Some RMS items within these sections will capture responses in a text box and some items provided restricted or limited choices. When RMS asks:

- NASA Sponsoring Directorate, select NASA Science Mission Directorate (SMD).

- NASA Sponsoring Program, select the proposal's reviewing/funding division, e.g., Astrophysics Division (APD), etc.
- Requested Start Date, enter the start date from your NSPIRES cover page. Otherwise use 1/1/2027, which is the suggested start date for FINESST grants
- Project Duration (in years), enter either 1 or 2 or 3.
- Funding Type, select Research Opportunities in Space and Earth Science (ROSES). Funding types are listed in alphabetical order. You may need to scroll to make the correct selection.
- ROSES Year, select 2025
- Program Element, select Future Investigators in NASA Earth and Space Science and Technology (FINESST).
- Funding Manager, select the name of funding division's FINESST Program Scientist, i.e., Astrophysics (APD) = Roopesh Ojha, Earth (ESD) = Yaitza Luna-Cruz, Heliophysics (HPD) = Jared Bell, Planetary Science (PSD) = Nick Lang, and Biological and Physical Science (BPS) = Ursula Koniges.

Computing time must be described in the request using Standard Billing Units (SBUs), a common unit of measurement employed by the HEC program for allocating and tracking computing usage across its various computing architectures. The RMS has a built-in calculator to help convert processor (CPU) hours to SBUs, or proposers may contact HEC support staff for further assistance calculating SBUs. Contact information can be found at https://www.nas.nasa.gov/hecc/support/user_support.html for NAS User Support and <https://www.nccs.nasa.gov> for NCCS User Services Group.

Proposers also may submit requests for time on the Graphics Processing Units (GPUs) at either center. The unit for GPUs is GPU SBUs (GSBUs). The conversion factor for GSBUs is 11.9 GSBUs/GPU hour. If you are having difficulties using RMS and need technical support, then please email to support@hec.nasa.gov and specify in the subject line "NNH25ZDA001N-FINESST HEC Request". Please allow 72 hours for a response before sending a second email.

Upload Request for HEC Resources

Save a PDF copy of your request after submitting it using the link provided in RMS. During the proposal submission via NSPIRES:

- Upload the PDF version of your computing time request as a separate file from your proposal and select "Optional HEC request" as the document type when uploading.
- On the NSPIRES Cover Page Program Specific Questions section:
 - Check the box or answer yes to indicate that a request for HEC resources is included in the proposal, and
 - Enter the HEC Request Number provided by in the RMS-generated PDF.

12.17 What must be done in NSPIRES when submitting a proposal with an HEC appendix?

Section I(e)ii of [the ROSES-25 Summary of Solicitation](#) contains instructions to submit a request for HEC resources. Check the box on the proposal cover page indicating that a request for HEC resources is included in the proposal and enter the HEC Request

Number (specified on the PDF). Be sure to answer the HEC Program Specific Data question(s) on the NSPIRES Cover Page.

12.18 How are the HEC requests reviewed?

During the review of the proposed investigation, NASA will consider whether the computing time requested is an appropriate use of the highly constrained resources dedicated to FINESST and factor this into HEC selection decisions.

Award of your FINESST proposal does not guarantee that your HEC request will be fully allocated; it means that your HEC request is eligible to progress to the next step for evaluation by the HEC Program. While you are guaranteed some HEC time, it may differ from your request given resource and other constraints, see Section I(e)iii of [the ROSES-25 Summary of Solicitation](#).

12.19 How are HEC resources allocated?

If your proposal is selected for funding, your HEC request will be evaluated by the SMD's HEC Allocation Authority. SMD allocates quarterly in October, January, April and July. Out of cycle allocation requests are handled on a case-by-case basis. The HEC program will then issue letters identifying yearly allocations of HEC resources for the duration of the project, which again, may differ from your request due to limited availability of resources. If there are unexpected changes to computational needs, then PIs may request increased or decreased allocations of HEC resources. Requests for modifications also must be submitted via RMS.

Note: You may experience delays between award by the NSSC, HEC allocation notification and access to the system(s). Your FINESST grant or cooperative agreement issued by the NSSC must be in place before HEC resources will be allocated. To access NASA High-End Computing systems, you must also establish a NASA identity and set up an account at the computing center.

There also is a separate identity verification process conducted by other authorities at NASA who work in various security- and export control-related offices. Most identity verifications are processed within 9-14 business days or 3 to 4 calendar weeks. However, verification processing is case-by-case and may be longer or denied if there is a foreign national from a designated country or the People's Republic of China involved.

In accordance with NASA Procedural Requirement 1600.4A (Identity and Credential Management) and Foreign National Access. Management FNAM Operations Manual ([NAII 1600.4A](#)), NASA resources must be prioritized for U.S. citizens, and foreign national access to Logical (IT) systems requires stringent, multi-layered reviews. Scenarios that cause extended processing time or potential denial include:

- Delayed responses for additional information: Typically, the PI or FI must provide additional work description details or documentation regarding a foreign national's (FN) identity to satisfy FNAM security and Counterintelligence (CI/CT) reviews.
- Visa/Entry Verification: Part of the NASA check requires determining how long FNs are allowed to remain in the U.S. and proving they entered the country legally.

- **Affiliation with China or Designated Countries:** Per NPR 1600.4A, if a U.S. person or foreign national is affiliated with China or another designated country, the request must be elevated beyond the Center level to NASA Headquarters (e.g., Office of International and Interagency Relations) and external reviewers like Congressional Committees. This is the most significant cause of delays and can add many months to the HEC allocation process, or lead to a final denial of access based on Export Control or national security restrictions.

Allocation in full cannot be guaranteed, but SMD will make every attempt to satisfy the needs in the context of the overall set of requirements, resource constraints, and science priorities.

Please read the HEC allocation letter carefully, as it will contain instructions for setting up your account at NAS or NCCS. PIs must provide the name of the FI participant who may use the account and identify foreign national status in the HEC request abstract, where appropriate.

13. Ancillary Information for Awardees

FINESST awards are subject to the standard policies and provisions identified in [2 CFR 200](#). Also see [2 CFR 1800](#), and the "[NASA Grant and Cooperative Agreement Terms and Conditions January 2026 or newer](#)" and [the March 2025 version of the NASA Grant and Cooperative Agreement Manual \(GCAM\)](#) or newer available at <https://www.nasa.gov/grants-policy-and-compliance-team/#Regulations>.

13.1 Pre-award Costs

All new awards receive an automatic 90 days of pre-award spending approval. However, the FI's institution may choose not to exercise this option, their written policies take precedence. Expenses incurred more than 90 calendar days before the award require prior written approval from a NASA Grant Officer at the NSSC. All costs incurred before NASA makes the award are at the recipient's risk (i.e., NASA is not required to reimburse such costs if for any reason the recipient does not receive an award or if the award is less than anticipated and inadequate to cover such costs). Note that a proposed project's proposed start date may or may not be the same as its award date.

13.2 Period of Performance Changes and No Cost Extensions

Changes to the period of performance, including no cost extensions (NCEs), will follow normal NASA grant procedures. Go to <https://www.nasa.gov/centers-and-facilities/grants-2/> and scroll to find the section Request for Supplemental Grant and Cooperative Agreement Actions: Administrative Supplement Requests Templates. For a first or initial NCE, the recipient must notify the NSSC at least 10 calendar days before the end of the period of performance (POP). Subsequent NCEs are due NLT 45 days before the POP's end date.

- Have the AOR address your email to: NSSC-Admin-Supplement-Request@mail.nasa.gov adding these key data to the subject line i; NCE: ii) your NSSC-issued award number, a combination of 13 alphanumeric characters, that starts with "80NSSC", and PI's name. Do not use the FINESST proposal number generated by NSPIRES.

1) Select the No Cost Extension (NCE) Request Form: 2) Fill out and save the completed NSSC's NCE PDF Form to your system. 3) Attach the saved i) NCE PDF; ii) your Research Performance Progress Reports (RPPR); and iii) if applicable, any other supporting documents, such as a revised budget to the email.

For POP changes unrelated to NCEs please use the NSSC's separate template [Period of Performance \(POP\) Change Form](#) and email to NSSC-Admin-Supplement-Request@mail.nasa.gov adding key data to subject line i; POP change: ii) your NSSC-issued award number.

13.3 FIs and PIs Transfers/Moves Versus PI and FI changes

Consistent with standard NASA award policies, a "transfer" refers only to cases where a current award or pending award is relinquished (given up or declined) by the awarded or submitting institution. If the NSSC has awarded the funding to an organization and the FI and PI want that money to move to a new institution, then that is NOT possible. If only the PI is leaving, then SMD will turn down the request to move/transfer a potential or a funded FINESST.

If post-initial notification from SMD via NSPIRES and prior to the NSSC-issuing an award, the submitting PI leaves, then the AOR contacts the FINESST POC named in the NSPIRES notification letter. The AOR notifies the SMD's potential funder whether they 1) will be turning down the FINESST or 2) naming a new PI, called a PI change.

When a FINESST proposal is chosen during the initial assessment after both the PI and FI together have moved to the same new organization, then the transferring PI and FI and a new AOR must resubmit the proposal using the same research via NSPIRES using ROSES's F.99 Principal Investigator Organization Change, after receiving instructions from the appropriate NASA POC in Section 11.

In extremely rare circumstances, FINESST awards may follow a transferring student to a new institution with a new PI. The SMD Division funding the award may consider funding such a FI on a single source proposal, i.e., a non-competitive, invitation-only mechanism or, if time permits, ask that a transfer proposal be submitted to an open FINESST solicitation.

AOR's submit any pre-NSSC-issued-award PI change requests in the form of an email to appropriate SMD technical officer in Section 11 with a copy to HQ-FINESST@mail.nasa.gov.

PI changes, that is when the submitting (original) PI leaves the FINESST project and the institution wants to continue the project, follow the normal NASA award processes explained on the [Principal Investigator \(PI\) Change Request Form](#) under the section Request for Supplemental Grant and Cooperative Agreement Actions at <https://www.nasa.gov/centers-and-facilities/grants-2/>.

There is no equivalent process for changing the FI at the submitting or awarded institution.

- Beginning with FINESST-25 awards, if a current FI graduates and leaves the project before the end (or start) of the period of performance, then the institution normally is not allowed to name a successor FI.

- Some institutions enforce written policies that do not permit the naming of a successor FI.
- Make sure the organization's sponsored programs office (i.e., the grant's AOR) is notified before reaching out to NASA.

If an FI leaves the institution prior to completing the awarded research project or ceases to participate in the FINESST but remains at the institution, then the AOR, PI, or FI email the technical officer, who most commonly is a funding POC listed in Section 11. SMD, in conjunction with the NSSC, decides on a case-by-case basis how to proceed. Most commonly the awarded institution will relinquish the award and the end date of the award will change to an earlier date.

13.4 Progress Reports

Progress reports are due no later than 60 days prior to the anniversary of the award's period of performance (POP) start. Some divisions request reports annually by March 15, regardless of the POP's start date. As is normal for NASA grants under 2 CFR 200, this program requires the Research Performance Progress Report (RPPR) see Sections 29.1 and 29.8 and Appendix C of the newest GCAM. Regardless of initial performance start date, progress reports are due annually. Make sure the RPPR covers 12 months of activities, including planned activities, particularly when submitting weeks and months in advance.

An optional FINESST RPPR template is available at <https://science.nasa.gov/researchers/sara/faqs/#faq-11>

All FINESST progress report emails must have a subject line that states 1) the NSSC issued award number, which is a combination of 13 alphanumeric characters, that will start with "80NSSC", 2) the PI Name, and 3) the Institution Name. Failure to use and include the three items in the email subject line may significantly delay processing.

Email NSSC-GrantReport@mail.nasa.gov and the technical officer (TO) identified on the Notification of Award (NASA Form 1687) the annual progress report as a PDF attachment. Do not send links in lieu of a PDF.

13.5 Is there NASA support for individuals receiving funding who experience discrimination or harassment during their work?

Students, faculty or staff in programs receiving NASA financial assistance, such as grants from this program, may raise allegations of discrimination, including harassment, by contacting the NASA Office Equal Opportunity (OEO). Find details on how to file a complaint via U.S. email or email hq-civilrightsinfo@mail.nasa.gov at <https://www.nasa.gov/external-civil-rights-compliance/>.

NASA does not offer support services. However, depending on the individual's employment status at the grantee institution, local support resources may be available through a union, a Veteran and Military Affairs (VMA) Office; the State-level equivalent of the Equal Employment Opportunity Commission (EEOC), etc. Many higher education institutions have support resources for non-employees, e.g., students, such as but not limited to health services, and community service officers. A search of the

recipient/applicant institution's website may help to locate resources related to bias, bullying, harassment, etc.

Assault or threats of assault of any kind are criminal offenses over which NASA has no authority. NASA strongly encourages assault victims and witnesses to report to the local police, and if applicable campus police, and the NASA Office of the Inspector General at <https://oig.nasa.gov/contact.html>. Always report immediate threats to 911.

13.6 What if the FI graduates or obtains a degree but still has project work to do? May they stay as the FI? What if an FI leaves or loses interest before the proposal review process is over or the award is issued?

If an FI obtains a degree in under three years and is continuing as a Ph.D. student at the awarded institution, then the FINESST grant continues. Continued studies is not a change in scope. It is not considered a change in scope when the FI continues with the same project at the same institution after graduation.

After completing a terminal degree (e.g., master's or Ph.D.) and no further studies are planned, if there is a year or less remaining on the FINESST award, and if it is acceptable to the awarded institution, the FI may remain at the grantee institution to continue the research, but no additional funds will be sent. If there are no changes to the budget cost categories, it is not necessary to contact NASA. Please include this information in the final performance report, or when requesting a no-cost extension (NCE), in the progress report submitted as part of the NCE.

However, should the awarded institution need to move funding from participant support costs to another direct cost category or to indirect, then a revised budget must be provided to the Grant Officer at the NSSC to approve before proceeding. Follow the instructions on the [Other Administrative Supplement Request Form](https://www.nasa.gov/centers-and-facilities/grants-2/) at <https://www.nasa.gov/centers-and-facilities/grants-2/>.

If the FI leaves before the review process is over or there is no award in place, the AOR only contacts the future award's SMD technical officer (see Section 11) and copies the HQ-FINESST@mail.nasa.gov. Alternatively, at any time before SMD updates a proposal status to announce a decision, the AOR may withdraw the proposal from NSPIRES and no email is needed.

13.7 Are PI or Co-I etc. Costs Allowable on a FINESST Award?

In most cases, no. FINESST awards are intended to support only student projects and research and therefore no salary, travel, or other costs shall be requested from SMD for the PIs, Co-Is, or Collaborators. When noted in the budget or doing award close out, rare exceptions for joint publication or similar costs may be permitted to the PI.